

August

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Underwater crossing **1870**

The Tower Subway, a tunnel dug underneath the River Thames in London, UK, opened to the public. Inside the tunnel, wooden railway carriages carried passengers from one side of the river to the other. The tunnel later became a walkway.

Also on this day

1776 In North America, 13 British colonies signed the US Declaration of Independence, pronouncing the end of British rule.

1944 Thousands of Romani people were killed by the Nazis at Auschwitz concentration camp in Poland. This day is now remembered as Roma Holocaust Memorial Day.

1990 Led by dictator Saddam Hussein, Iraqi troops invaded neighbouring Kuwait, leading to the start of the first Gulf War.

1971

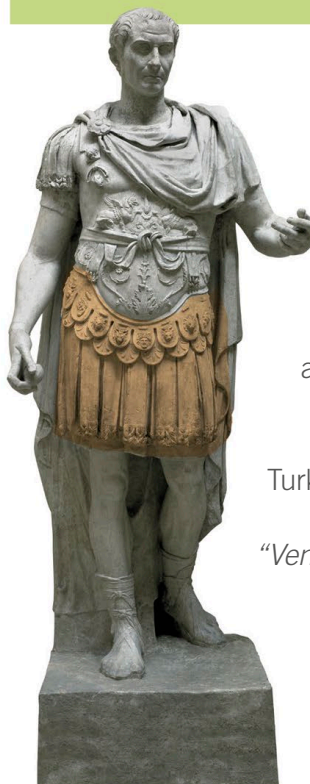
Memorial on the Moon

The crew of the US mission *Apollo 15* placed a small sculpture named Fallen Astronaut on the Moon, together with a plaque showing the names of 14 US and Russian astronauts who lost their lives while working to advance space exploration.



Born this day

1979 Reuben Kosgei, Kenyan athlete. Aged 21, he became the youngest-ever winner of Olympic gold in the 3,000 m steeplechase.



47 BCE

Winning general

Roman military general Julius Caesar won a major victory against the Kingdom of Pontus at the Battle of Zela in modern-day Turkey. Caesar celebrated his win by declaring, “*Veni, vidi, vici*” (“I came, I saw, I conquered”).